COURSE OUTLINE · 2026

Project Controls, governed

The full PCI PCL-AI syllabus. 13 domains, 61 knowledge areas, and the arithmetic each one is examined on.

The formulas are in here ⟶

THE PROBLEM

A CPI of 1.19 and 1.05 from the same month

Earned value 2,200,000. Invoiced cost 1,850,000. Skip the accrual and **CPI = 1.19**. Book the 240,000 of work already done and **CPI = 1.05**.

Fourteen points on one missing entry, and next month the un-accrued version shows an overrun that never happened.

> Cut-off is not bookkeeping hygiene. It is the difference between a performance index that means something and one that **whipsaws with invoice timing**.

WHAT THE SYLLABUS COVERS

Thirteen domains. No filler.

13
domains

61
knowledge areas

26
sector case studies

> Every technique arrives with **the conditions under which it fails**. A method you cannot break is a method you do not yet understand.

PART ONE · 40% OF THE BODY OF KNOWLEDGE

Finance, accounting and reporting

1
5 KAs

Foundations of accounting for project controls

The accounting model · Components of the financial statements · Accrual accounting and the matching concept · Cost provisions and cost accruals · Chart of accounts and cost coding for projects

2
5 KAs

Financial reporting and the standards

The reporting framework · IFRS 15 Revenue from Contracts with Customers · Revenue recognition beyond the basics · Other relevant standards for project controls · Management reporting versus statutory reporting

3
5 KAs

Budgeting and forecasting

Budgeting fundamentals · Cost estimation · The time-phased budget, or cost baseline (planned value) · Forecasting · Cash-flow forecasting

4
4 KAs

Performance management, variance analysis and management reporting

Performance management principles · Variance analysis · Management reporting · Data visualisation and storytelling for controls

DOMAINS 1–2 · WHAT YOU ARE EXAMINED ON

Getting the number right

Assets = Liabilities + Equity — the identity every ledger must satisfy

PoC = cost to date / total estimated cost — cost-to-cost percentage of completion

revenue = PoC × transaction price — revenue for the period to date

period revenue = cumulative – prior — what actually lands in this month

Contract asset (liability) = cumulative revenue – cumulative billed

over- or under-billing, on the balance sheet

> Recognition is not billing. A project can be profitable, fully billed and **still carry a contract liability**.

PART TWO · 40% OF THE BODY OF KNOWLEDGE

Project management

5
4 KAs

Cost management and cost control

The cost management framework · The cost control cycle · Cost breakdown and control accounts · Change control and cost impact

6
4 KAs

Earned value management and forecasting

EVM fundamentals · Variances and performance indices · Forecasting with EVM: the EAC family · Integrating cost and schedule, limitations, earned schedule

7
5 KAs

Contracts, commercial management, BoQ, invoicing and revenue

Types of contract · Contract management · Bills of quantities · Invoicing and applications for payment · Revenue recognition in the commercial cycle

8
6 KAs

Project management lifecycle

Initiating · Planning · Executing · Monitoring and controlling · Closing · Development approaches: predictive, iterative, incremental and adaptive

Four measures, one month-end

$CV = EV - AC$	cost variance
$SV = EV - PV$	schedule variance, in money
$CPI = EV / AC$	cost performance index
$SPI = EV / PV$	schedule performance index
$SV(t) = ES - AT$	earned schedule variance, in time
$SPI(t) = ES / AT$	the index that still works near completion

DOMAIN 6 · THE HEART OF IT

There is no ‘the’ EAC

$EAC = AC + (BAC - EV)$

the overrun was one-off; the rest runs to plan

$EAC = BAC / CPI$

performance to date persists — usually the honest default

$EAC = AC + (BAC - EV)/(CPI \times SPI)$

cost and schedule pressure both continue

$EAC = AC + ETC$

the team re-estimated the remaining work bottom-up

> Four methods. Four assumptions. Four different answers from the same data. **Naming which one you used, and why, is the skill.**

PART TWO · CONTINUED

Delivery, schedule, process and risk

9
6 KAs

Agile, Scrum and adaptive delivery for project controls

Agile foundations · The Scrum framework in depth · Backlogs, estimation and agile metrics · Kanban, Lean and scaling · Agile cost control, forecasting and earned value · Hybrid delivery and agile governance

10
4 KAs

Project scheduling, in depth

Schedule development · Network analysis and the critical path method · Schedule compression and resourcing · Progress measurement and schedule control

11
3 KAs

Business process cycles

Order-to-cash · Procure-to-pay · Internal control and segregation of duties

12
3 KAs

Risk management for project controls

The risk framework · The risk process · Contingency and management reserve

DOMAINS 4, 9, 11, 12

Where the money actually moves

Price/rate = (actual price − standard price) × actual quantity

price variance

usage/efficiency = (actual quantity − standard quantity) × standard price

usage variance — the other half of the story

EV = (points done / total points) × BAC

earned value when scope is a backlog

CCC = DSO + DIO − DPO

cash conversion cycle, in days

EMV = probability × impact

expected monetary value — how risk enters a forecast

PART THREE · 20% OF THE BODY OF KNOWLEDGE

AI, governed

13
7 KAs

AI for project controls and project management

AI foundations for professionals · Data: the fuel · Prompting and working with generative AI · AI tool categories for project controls and PM · AI applied across the project-controls lifecycle · Governance, ethics, risk and assurance of AI · Building an AI-augmented project-controls capability

> The largest domain in the volume, and the reason the credential exists in this form. It ends where every automated output should end: with **a named human who verified it**.

DOMAIN 13 · THE PART MOST COURSES SKIP

Is the model worth running?

precision = true hits ÷ total flags

of everything it flagged, how much was real

recall = true hits ÷ total true cases

of everything real, how much it caught

F1 = 2 × (precision × recall) ÷ (precision + recall)

the single number that refuses to let you game either

net = annual saving – annual cost

the only test a sponsor actually asks

> A model with 99% recall and 4% precision buries your team in false positives. **"The AI found something" is not a control.**

WHAT SITS BEHIND THE SYLLABUS

113 standards. 532 process requirements.

Each states its purpose, who owns the decision, what evidence must exist, what practice is prohibited, what triggers escalation, **what AI may never decide, approve or certify** — and a compliance test an assessor can perform.

They are certification requirements established by the Institute. They are not legislation, and nothing here is legal, tax or accounting advice.

THE PRINCIPLE BEHIND ALL OF IT

AI proposes. The professional verifies, decides and remains accountable.

The full outline and the three Bodies of Knowledge — projectcontrolsinstitute.org